SMALL BUSINESS ACCELERATOR

Small Business Accelerator Online Syllabus

Powered by

GOVCON GIANTS
WINNING CONTRACTS LIKE BOEING!

GOVCON EDU

ALCHEMY GOV
ADV GOV

Table of contents

Course Description **2**

Learning Outcomes **2**

Format Of Class **2**

Instructor Office Hours and Communication **3**

GovconEDU Course Plan Overview **3**

Week One: Introduction to Federal Procurement 3
Week Two: Small Business Fundamentals 4
Week Three: SAM Registration and Certifications 5
Week Four: Contract Opportunities 6
Week Five: Teaming Partners 7
Week Six: Market Research Essentials 8
Week Seven: Business Development 9
Week Eight: Proposal Writing 9
Week Nine: Pricing Strategies 10
Week Ten: Contract Compliance and Performance Management 11
Lunch & Learn Webinars 13

Course Description

The GovconEDU course is designed to provide small business owners and entrepreneurs with the knowledge and skills they need to successfully pursue and win federal government contracts. Through a series of lectures, case studies, and interactive exercises, participants will learn about the federal contracting process, regulations, and requirements for small businesses. Participants will learn the nuts and bolts of the federal contracting process, how to identify and pursue federal government contract opportunities and earn a certificate of completion from GovconEDU, Govcon Giants (GCG) and AlchemyGov. The course examines compliance with federal regulations and requirements, Small Business Administration (SBA) regulations, and the Buy American Act. For example students will learn how to prepare competitive proposals, including the development of technical and price proposals, and navigating the bid protest process.

Learning Outcomes

This course focuses on the application of terms processes and the economics of what is included in a standard federal request for proposal. We teach students how to navigate government websites for data mining, utilizing this data to make decisions and then applying it to daily business practices. The course aims to provide its students with a core set of practical skills that every small business, entrepreneur, contract office stakeholder should master.

Format Of Class

This class combines lectures, exercises, and in-person discussions - delivered online. This class is largely asynchronous, which means that you are not required to participate at the same time and place as other students in the class. Students are encouraged to complete the online tasks according to the suggested weekly schedule. You choose what time of day you are “in class.” We recommend setting a daily “class/study time” that fits your schedule and adhere to it during the course. Students should set aside around 3-4 hours each week for this course.

During the 10 weeks of the course, we have scheduled weekly office hours with instructors to provide opportunities for “live” discussion with them and your classmates that occur at scheduled times. These will vary, but most will be held on Tuesday’s at 10:00am ET.

Instructor Office Hours and Communication

Office hours will be held each during the 10-week syllabus on most Tuesdays at 10:00am ET via Zoom. Exact dates and the Zoom link will be provided on the Teachable course platform.

The office hours are designed to be similar to the experience you would have if you were a student on campus. You can attend and ask questions you may have about the course, the materials, or the lectures; however to be respectful of our instructors time, we will send a weekly reminder of office hours and request students who will be attending to respond by 6pm the evening prior to the scheduled office hour.

The class will be notified if the office hours are rescheduled. Communication with the entire class about important course updates and notifications will be done using announcements within the Teachable platform. All course-related announcements and communication will be conducted via this platform, so please make sure you have checked your Teachable notification/email settings.

Certificate Eligibility

The program is designed to be completed in 10 weeks but you will have access to the platform for 5 months to complete all the requirements. The modules must be done in order (ie. completing one module will "unlock" the next). If you have questions or concerns regarding a quiz, please submit a comment on the quiz page in question. In addition to watching all the sessions (lectures, interviews, and modules), a student must achieve a combined total average of 75% or higher on the graded quizzes and make a good faith effort on Document submission. Once you have finished the course, you must complete the post-program survey in order to receive your certificate. Certificates will be awarded on a rolling monthly basis beginning in early June.

GovconEDU Course Plan Overview

Week One: Introduction to Federal Procurement

Office hours: Erika Baltazar, Resource Specialist | GovconEDU

1.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
1.1	**Does the government buy what you sell?** In this video Eric takes you through a series of steps using free public websites to determine; (1) How they buy your services? (2) How much of your services do they buy? (3) Where do they buy them? and (4) Who buys them?
1.2	**Prime Contractor versus Subcontractor** Eric Coffie discusses the difference between a prime contractor and a subcontractor

	working for a US federal agency. We discussed the roles and responsibilities of each party as it pertains to a contract.
1.3	**Are you ready to do federal contracts as a Prime?** In this video we help small businesses determine whether or not they are ready to become a prime contractor. Using key performance indicators a company can determine the appropriate course of action to take for their business.
1.4	**Small Business Perspective: Market Research Based Strategies** Let the Market Research Guide your Decisions. Doing business with the government is a tricky subject. There are many different ways to break into the marketplace. This video outlines the process that many small businesses have used to increase their odds at winning federal contracts.
1.5	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Prime vs Subcontracting learning from successful contractors Angela O' Byrne of Perez APC. Angela O'Byrne is a passionate advocate for women and minorities in design, construction, and real estate development. Her firm has contracts throughout Africa, Europe and the Middle East.
1.6	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Steven Koprince of Koprince law firm shares his lists of top three legal issues facing small businesses. Koprince law firm produces the largest blog on legal matters affecting small business government contractors smallgovcon.com.

Week Two: Small Business Fundamentals

Office hours: Maria Martinez, Chairperson | Govcon Giants

2.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
2.1	**Types of Purchases** Kimberly Yates former head of Contracting 1102 (unlimited warrant) discuss the three most common ways the government buys from small businesses. In this video we explain how SMB can build a strategy using credit card purchase, micro purchase and Simplified Acquisition Procedures (SAP).
2.2	**Moving from competitive to non-competitive** Federal regulations permit contract officers to solicit small businesses on a best value basis. As a preferred contractor or vendor in the federal arena a sub agency is likely to solicit your firm for negotiated contracts. This is standard procedure when

	doing business at the federal level.
2.3	**What components do I need for my brand?** The most important part of preparing SMBs to do business with federal agencies is presenting your company as federal contract ready. That starts with creating a federal procurement branding strategy. DOD and Non-DOD buyers, program managers,and KOs have a minimum expectation of a government contractor business. Some key takeaways to consider when developing your brand.
2.4	**Avoid Common Capability Statement Mistakes** Learn how to build capability statements that get READ! What is a capability statement? Why is it important? Who will read it? Your cap statement will be viewed by federal agencies, teaming partners, and primes. Learn the most common mistakes made by SMBs, do's and don'ts when crafting your capability statement.
2.5	**Live Student Capability Statement Reviews** In this video we review capability statements from students and offer critique and suggestions for improvement. Use this lesson to see various opinions and insights from an outside perspective.

Week Three: SAM Registration and Certifications

Office hours: Maria Martinez, Chairperson | Govcon Giants

3.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
3.1	**SAM Registration** System for Award Management is the portal used to register your entity in order to do business with the federal government. Without this registration the government will not be able to award you prime contracts. It is a FREE website that is also required when seeking grant awards.
3.1.1	**NAICS** The North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) is the standard used by Federal statistical agencies in classifying business establishments for the purpose of collecting, analyzing, and publishing statistical data related to the U.S. business economy. Learn how these codes are used for determining the size of your business as it pertains to federal procurement.
3.1.2	**PSC Codes**

	Product Service Codes (PSCs) classify products, services, and research and development items purchased by the federal government.
3.2	**SBA Profile (Dynamic Small Business Search "DSBS")** When completing your SAM registration you have the option to create an SBA profile in conjunction with your registration. The DSBS portal is not required to be eligible for government contract awards. Learn how to build your SBA profile and why creating the right DSBS profile is important to your business. Learn about agency market research reports and how this relates to your DSBS profile .
3.3	**Small Business Certification Overview** Explore FAR Part 19 Small Business programs and set asides. Small Disadvantaged Business, HUBZone business, Woman Owned Small Business and Veteran Owned Small Business.
3.4	**Utilizing Small Business Certifications** Each socio economic set aside has a unique set of properties. In this lecture we discuss how to maximize Small Disadvantaged Business, HUBZone business, Woman Owned Small Business and Veteran Owned Small Business.
3.5	**SBA Award Winner Perspective:** Angela O' Byrne discusses how after being in the 8a BD program for 8 years she finally found her stride on the way to winning the largest ever contract for a women owned business at that time. She is an award winning Internationally known architect and president of Design Build firm Perez APC.
3.6	**SBA Award Winner Perspective:** Mark Masters of Chloeta what is needed to maximize the 8a program. Chloeta supports military, energy, homeland security, emergency preparedness, and critical infrastructure.

Week Four: Contract Opportunities

Office hours: Maria Martinez, Chairperson | Govcon Giants

4.0	**SAM Search Introduction** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
4.1	**Explore System for Award Management (SAM) searches** In this video we explore SAM.gov, the government point of entry (GPE) for government business opportunities greater than $25,000 that can be accessed electronically by the public. We teach you what data to look for, how it can be used for research and how to interpret the data.
4.2	**Sources Sought / RFI's and why they are important**

	In this lesson we discuss FAR Part 10 policies and procedures for federal agencies conducting market research to arrive at the most suitable approach to acquiring, distributing, and supporting supplies and services. We highlight who should respond, why to respond, how and where to respond. FAR 15.201(e) FAR 10.002(b)(2)(iii), FAR 5.201(c), FAR 19.501(c)
4.3	**Viewing 100s of entries on SAM** Eric shares lessons he learned how to extract and analyze hundreds of data points from SAM.gov. This technique will be critical to maximizing resources, saving time and money. With 100's of entries entered weekly, learning how to search, extract and read the information quickly and easily is critical to SME business development strategy.
4.4	**What is Micro Purchase and SAP** Time to learn how most new businesses begin federal procurement with little to no federal past performance. There is a government program that exclusively uses small businesses but it is not considered a set-aside. In this lesson we discuss how powerful FAR Part 13 Simplified Acquisition Procedures.
4.5	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Venus Quates do you have your stuff together. Delivering excellence to all.

Week Five: Teaming Partners

Office hours: Maria Martinez, Chairperson | Govcon Giants

5.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
5.1	**Explaining the rules for subcontracting** In this section we highlight FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting. What is the percentage of work to be completed by the Prime Contractor vs the Subcontractor.
5.2	**Difference between joint ventures and teaming** Joint Ventures are typically created between two entities who want to take advantage of unique attributes. For purposes of utilizing a set aside procurement or small business status we cover 13 CFR 125.8. For clarification on teaming agreements we visit FAR Subpart 9.6.
5.3	**Finding a partner with a certification** Knowing the rules for participation in set aside / small business procurement we can now look for partners to participate on current / future solicitations. We will cover

	how to identify partners and convince them to work with you in this lesson.
5.4	**How to spot companies that need subcontractors** Solving client problems is critical to how successful firms grow and thrive. Today we discuss how to identify those firms with immediate needs versus long term needs. Building a pipeline of customers / agencies is critical to staying in business for the long haul.
5.5	**Subcontracting from Primes** Defense contracting firms must meet small business goals like government agencies. One strategy for breaking into the government sector is through subcontracting. What should I be saying to major primes in order to find subcontractor work with large prime contractors? What is a small business liaison officer and why are they important?
5.6	**Entrepreneur Perspective**: David Ramajahn: Starting out with Teaming partners.
5.7	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Brian Henry of Henry Contractors discusses the benefits of working with 8a graduates.

Week Six: Market Research Essentials

Office hours: Ena Ortiz, Head of Research | AlchemyGov

6.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
6.1	**What is capture vs business development** Learning industry terms and what they mean for building out your federal pipeline and hiring appropriate team members to help you in that quest.
6.2	**Finding Government Buyers** Government agencies must report all contract activities, spending, changes, task order requests, value spent, modifications everything to do with a contract. Today we explore two databases: usaspending and federal procurement data systems (fpds.gov) to search for government buyers who have purchased products / services similar to ours in the past.
6.3	**What Information should you be gathering about agencies**

	Federal organizations publish a ton of useful information about their organization. Knowing what is most important to gather can be helpful when approaching them for opportunities.
6.4	**Indefinite Delivery vehicles (IDV)** In an effort to be efficient, the federal government forecasts a list of procurement needs and pre-approves a vendor pool of contractors to handle fulfilling those requests. This is SOP in the federal government and allows them to handle tens of thousands of orders utilizing a few hundred contracts. Another tool for small businesses looking to maximize growth potential.
6.5	**Entrepreneur Perspective: Angela Terry -** Utilizing public systems for federal contracting. SBA subcontracting platform Subnet explained by Subcontracting program manager, Angela Terry.

Week Seven: Business Development

Office hours: Randie Ward, President | AlchemyGov

7.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
7.1	**Using agency Forecast List Overview** Lesson 6.2 we discussed what information you should be gathering during your research phase of your journey. In this section we explain the relationship between the forecast list and your business development activities.
7.2	**Top 5 federal lead sources** The government is the largest buyer of goods and services. Therefore when looking at an organization of massive scale it is important to understand who you should be talking to. Knowing potential lead sources will make your journey significantly easier.
7.3	**How to find and set up a meeting with an agency** In the previous section we discussed the top lead sources, today we uncover where to find small business specialist / OSDBU and SBLO. At the end we explain how to contact them and what to expect.
7.4	**Roles and responsibilities of contract officers** The highest visibility persons in procurement are contracting officers and contracting officer representatives. For that reason so many of us believe that they are the gateway to landing our first federal contract, unfortunately this is far from the truth. Today we discuss how to maximize the use of contracting officials.

	Position Classification Standard for Contracting Series, GS-1102
7.5	**Prepare for the call** Before you pick up the phone to call a federal representative about an opportunity we want to prepare you for what to expect. Making a great first impression is important, but also maximizing the time spent for both parties is critical to the process of advancing your cause of winning a contract.
7.6	**Conferences and events** There are literally hundreds of events each year, choosing the right ones to attend is a smart and prudent way to do business. Today's lesson we teach you our method of choosing which events to attend throughout the year.
7.7	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Researching Forecast List with Nikki Bradshaw of Miami Nation Enterprises (nikki eric forecast list research)
7.8	**SBA Award Winner Perspective:** Attending Conferences and events is one thing but what should you be doing when you arrive, a brief conversation with Orlando Espinosa.

7.9	**SBLO Perspective:** Amber Hanlon - As the Small Business Liaison Officer for Collins Aerospace, Amber Hanlon is responsible for a wide range of activities that support small businesses.

Week Eight: Proposal Writing

Office hours: Eric Coffie, CEO | Govcon Giants, AlchemyGov

8.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
8.1	**Solicitation structure explained** While there are 100's of ways to purchase an item, the structure of the solicitation does not vary greatly. Today we explore the most common solicitation structures for federal proposals.
8.2	**How I format my proposal (Section L & M)** Since the majority of federal solicitations require a written proposal, writing an effective response makes all the difference between winning versus losing a contract. Today we take a deep dive into proposal formatting, the foundation for

	creating a winning response.
8.3	**How to respond to a Sources Sought / RFI notice?** Government buyers are looking to exchange information with companies before a solicitation is ever issued.(FAR 15.201) The better you can communicate effectively with the government in the manner that they request, the more likely you are to be considered for a contract opportunity.

Week Nine: Proposal Pricing

Office hours: Eric Coffie, CEO | Govcon Giants, AlchemyGov

9.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
9.1	**How to Estimate a Government Bid Overview** When submitting a RFP response part of the evaluation criteria involves analyzing how you price a project. In this lesson we will show you how to justify your pricing to the government using the GSA database (GSA calc) as a guide. This will help you to remain compliant with FAR and win more contract negotiations. We deep dive into Davis Bacon, pricing equipment and labor rates.
9.2	**How to determine what rates to charge** When submitting a RFP response part of the evaluation criteria involves analyzing how you price a project. In this lesson we will show you how to justify your pricing to the government using the GSA database (GSA calc) as a guide. This will help you to remain compliant with FAR and win more contract negotiations. We deep dive into Davis Bacon, pricing equipment and labor rates.
9.3	**How to determine what rates to charge** When submitting a RFP response part of the evaluation criteria involves analyzing how you price a project. In this lesson we will show you how to justify your pricing to the government using the GSA database (GSA calc) as a guide. This will help you to remain compliant with FAR and win more contract negotiations. We deep dive into Davis Bacon, pricing equipment and labor rates.
9.4	**Determining the subcontract % of work** In the previous section we highlight FAR 52.219-14 Limitations on Subcontracting. What is the percentage of work to be completed by the Prime Contractor vs the Subcontractor. In this lesson we show you how a small business can use subcontractors and still remain compliant.
9.5	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Pricing is an art. Explained by Jennifer Namvar, former

	Capture Manager for Leidos, the #1 defense contractor in the world.

Week Ten: Contract Compliance and Performance Management

Office hours: Eric Coffie, CEO | Govcon Giants, AlchemyGov

10.0	**Module Overview** Eric Coffie highlights learning objectives in this module.
10.1	**Negotiations (Profit 15.4)** Unlike state and local contracting, the federal government negotiates the vast majority of all their contracts prior to award. Learning how to improve your negotiations is vital to achieving maximum profitability.
10.2	**Termination Clauses (T4C)** Every once in a while a project does not go as planned. We want all contractors to understand where to turn in the case that contract termination may appear to be the only viable option on the table.
10.3	**Small Business Programs (part 19)** With nearly 30% of all contracts going to small businesses for some agencies, part 19 of the FAR is as critical as contract performance. As a business owner it is imperative that you learn the key components of this section to create opportunities and stay compliant.
10.4	**Notifications, protests, mistakes (part 15.5)** Operating in the federal arena requires tenacity. When submitting proposals they are evaluated by humans who occasionally make mistakes. Knowing what rights you have beyond accepting that you were not the successful awardee is a must. This chapter of the FAR covers remedies in the event that you were not awarded the contract.
10.5	**Contract Cost - Overhead rates (part 31)** In a previous section we discussed pricing projects utilizing government standard rates. In this case we are learning what are allowable costs and how to determine overhead rates as per government rules and regulations.
10.6	**Simplified Acquisition Procedures (part 13)** As a small business contractor entering the federal arena, learning all that is available will help your team develop a strategy that makes sense given your unique

	situation. Today's lesson we explain another contract vehicle that is unique to the federal arena that offers small businesses a chance at contract opportunities that are not full and open.
10.7	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Attorney Margery Newman discusses dangerous contract clauses for subcontractors.
10.8	**Entrepreneur Perspective:** Alexander Hassan professor of contract management serves at Defense Acquisition University.

Academy 3.0 Course Catalog

Active	**Not required for certificate eligibility** The Academy 3.0 video library is exclusively provided to Small Business Accelerator ONLINE participants by invitation only. Although these are not necessary for certificates of eligibility, they have been added to a separate course catalog for those who would like to watch the recordings. You will have access to the video repository for the duration of your plan.